

INTERNAL • FOUNDERS

SFDesk

What the product actually does today, in plain language — plus a reasoned recommendation on how to split it into Basic / Studio / Pro.

PREPARED FOR

Co-founders

FROM

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STATUS

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HOW TO READ THIS

Part one is a capability list — everything a shop owner can actually do in the product right now, grouped by area. Part two is tiers: what's already technically split into Basic/Studio/Pro in the code, and then a recommendation — numbers and reasoning, not a decision — for where to land on pricing. Nothing here is charged yet; the marketing site currently shows all three tiers as "Coming soon" on purpose.

01	What SFDesk is, in one paragraph	05	What it deliberately doesn't do
02	Catalog & inventory	06	Tiers — what's already built
03	Order desk & the public storefront	07	Pricing recommendation
04	Team, data & integrations		

01 What SFDesk is, in one paragraph

SFDesk is order-and-catalog software for small sellers who currently run their business through Instagram and WhatsApp DMs instead of a real store or website.

Today that looks like: a seller posts products on Instagram, a customer messages to order, and from there everything — the price agreed, the address, whether it's been paid, whether it's shipped — lives buried in a chat thread with no record anywhere else. SFDesk replaces that with two linked pieces:

THE STOREFRONT

A public link (`sfdesk.1k/s/shopname`) the seller drops in their Instagram bio. Customers browse a real catalog, build a basket, and send it straight to the seller's WhatsApp as a formatted message — **there is no checkout and never will be**. It's a tidier way to place the same DM order, not a payment page.

THE ORDER DESK

Where the seller actually runs the business: the catalog, every order tracked from placed → confirmed → packed → delivered → paid, customers, and exports. Built phone-first, for someone running this one-handed between other things.

POSITIONING

It's pitched as the correctly-scoped middle step between "no system at all" and "a full e-commerce website" — priced and built for a business that doesn't yet need Shopify, with a real, non-rebuild path up to a full website later (the Pro tier's API + discount, see §07).

02 Catalog & inventory

Everything a seller needs to list what they sell and keep stock honest.

PRODUCTS

Name, description, SKU, category (free text), price, currency (per-shop, defaults LKR), and multiple photos per product.

PHOTOS

Multi-photo upload per product, resized and converted to WebP client-side before upload (keeps storage and page-weight down), stored on Cloudflare R2.

STOCK TRACKING

Optional per shop (on by default). When on, confirmed orders draw down quantity automatically and low-stock shows in the desk before a seller oversells. Every change is a logged stock movement, not just a silent number edit.

DISCOUNTS

Per-order discount, either a flat amount or a percentage — applied by the seller when confirming an order, not a coupon-code system.

BULK IMPORT

CSV import for products, so a seller migrating from a spreadsheet or another tool doesn't have to re-type their whole catalog by hand.

CATEGORIES

Free-text, not a separate managed table — deliberately simple so a seller never hits a "create category" wall. The storefront turns these into a real, URL-addressable filter + nav automatically.

03 The order desk & the public storefront

THE ORDER DESK

THREE INDEPENDENT STATUS AXES

Order (pending → confirmed → packed → shipped → delivered → completed, or cancelled/returned), **delivery** (pending → dispatched → delivered) and **payment** (unpaid → partial → paid) are tracked separately rather than one combined status — because in real life an order can be delivered and still unpaid, or paid up front and not yet packed.

FULL AUDIT TIMELINE

Every status change is logged with who changed it and when — an order has a real history, not just a current state.

MANUAL + STOREFRONT ORDERS

Orders can be entered directly in the desk (a customer who ordered by phone call, say) or arrive automatically from the public storefront — same pipeline either way.

CUSTOMERS

Every buyer is captured automatically from their order (name, phone, address, order history) — no separate "add a customer" step.

THE PUBLIC STOREFRONT

BROWSING

Responsive grid catalog, category filter and sort — both real, server-side and URL-addressable (shareable, reload-safe), not a client-side toggle.

THE HANDOFF

Cart → customer fills name/phone/address/city/payment preference (cash on delivery or bank transfer) → order is created *and* handed to WhatsApp (pre-filled) or Instagram (copied, DMs opened) for the seller to see it arrive the way they already do today.

BRANDING, TIERED

Logo, accent colour, banner, tagline/hero copy, font choice, background tone, and which sections show — see §06 for exactly which tier unlocks what.

PERFORMANCE

Storefront pages are cached at the edge (Cloudflare) — a warm page serves in ~10ms with zero database queries, so one busy shop can't slow down or cost more for everyone else.

What never changes, regardless of tier

No checkout, no payment processing, ever. The storefront is always **one configurable layout** — owners tune colours, fonts, copy, a banner and which sections show, but never add pages, rearrange the layout, or run a checkout. This is a permanent product constraint, not a v1 cut.

04 Team, data & integrations

ROLES (BUILT NOW, INVITES LATER)

Owner (everything, including billing), **Staff** (edit catalog, work orders, no billing/no deleting products), **Viewer** (read-only — an accountant or family member). The invite UI ships when the first account actually asks for it; the permission model is already built and enforced.

BUSINESS SETTINGS

Per-shop currency, default delivery fee, WhatsApp number, Instagram handle, policy/returns note, pause toggle (take the storefront offline without deleting anything).

EXPORTS

Customers, products and orders each export to CSV on demand — a seller's data is never locked in.

BACKUPS

Point-in-time database restore (Neon) plus a daily full backup copied off-platform — a bad delete or a platform incident isn't a data-loss event.

TENANT ISOLATION

Enforced at the database level (Postgres row-level security), not just in application code — one shop's data is structurally unreachable from another's, even if a bug in the app layer tried.

TRANSACTIONAL EMAIL

New-order notifications to the seller, password reset — sent from the shop's own branded domain (Resend, verified sending domain).

READ API

A read-only, tenant-scoped API (catalog + products) so an external website — built by any agency — can render a shop's catalog without touching the order desk database directly. Pro-tier gated (see §06).

PLATFORM ADMIN

An internal dashboard (not customer-facing) for plan/tier management and an audit log of every meaningful account change.

As important to a cofounder as what's built — these are permanent scope boundaries, not a v1 shortlist of things to add later.

PERMANENT, BY DESIGN

- **No payment processing, ever.** The storefront hands off to WhatsApp/Instagram; money changes hands however the seller already handles it (cash, bank transfer). This is a product principle, not a missing feature.
- **Not a website builder.** One configurable layout — never multi-page, never a drag-and-drop editor.
- **Not a custom build per client.** One codebase, one deploy. A feature either ships to every shop or it doesn't ship.

NOT YET, BUT THE MODEL SUPPORTS IT

- **Staff/viewer invites** — the roles and permissions already exist and are enforced; just no "invite a teammate" button yet.
- **Customer-facing order-confirmation emails** — buyers aren't asked for an email address today (WhatsApp is the confirmation channel); adding one is a small, deliberate feature addition, not a rearchitecture.
- **Multiple staff-facing languages** — currently English only.

06 Tiers — what's already built

The code already has a real three-tier entitlement system (`lib/entitlements.ts`), set manually per shop today since billing isn't wired up yet. This is the existing split — the question in §07 is just what to charge for it, not what each tier includes.

Basic

THE REPLACE-THE-DMS TIER

- Full catalog & order desk
- Public storefront
- Logo upload, accent colour
- Category nav, policy note
- Pause toggle, contact links
- Unlimited products & orders
- CSV exports

Studio

EVERYTHING IN BASIC, PLUS

- Banner image
- Tagline + hero headline/subhead
- Font choice (4 curated families)
- Second colour, background tone
- Section show/hide toggles
- Default product sort

Pro

EVERYTHING IN STUDIO, PLUS

- Read-only catalog API
- Remove "powered by SFDesk"
- 20% off a full website build
- — the stepping-stone tier for shops ready to graduate to a real website

HOW A DOWNGRADE BEHAVES

Stored Studio/Pro settings (a banner image, a chosen font) are **never deleted** on a downgrade — they just stop rendering on the storefront until the shop upgrades again. No re-entry, no data loss, no surprise 500 error. This was a deliberate build decision so tier changes are reversible and low-stakes for a seller to try.

07 Pricing recommendation

A recommendation to debate, not a decision already made — flagging that explicitly since the marketing site currently shows "Coming soon" on purpose.

The one fact that should anchor this: infra cost is not the constraint

Per-shop hosting cost at realistic small-seller traffic is a few cents a month (Cloudflare Workers + R2 + edge caching) — this was modelled separately. There is no cost floor forcing a minimum price. Pricing here is entirely a **willingness-to-pay and positioning** question, not a margin-protection one, which gives real room to price for adoption rather than for survival.

Tier	Suggested price	Why this number
Basic	LKR 2,000–2,500/mo	Low enough that "I'll just keep using WhatsApp" stops being the rational choice — the PRD's own stated goal is that budget should never be the objection at this tier. This replaces today's placeholder LKR 1,500 figure, nudged up slightly since Basic already includes the full order desk, not just a storefront.
Studio	LKR 4,000–4,500/mo	The tier most sellers who care about their brand will actually pick — priced near the ~LKR 4,500 figure already floated earlier as a realistic market price point. The roughly 2x step over Basic is justified by real, visible differentiation (banner, fonts, colour, hero copy) that a seller's own customers can see.
Pro	LKR 7,500–9,000/mo	A smaller, more intentional audience — shops already planning a real website. Price it as a qualifying signal more than a volume play: the real revenue from a Pro customer is the eventual website build, not the subscription. ~2x over Studio keeps the ladder's step-size consistent.

KEEP

The **14-day free trial, no card** — already built, removes signup friction, and costs nothing meaningful given the infra-cost finding above.

WORTH REINTRODUCING ONCE SET

An **annual discount** (the UI previously offered "2 months free" on annual billing) — improves cash flow and retention, standard practice, no reason not to bring it back once the monthly numbers are final.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THIS CONVERSATION

1	Does Studio land close enough to what you'd already been quoting prospects, or does that number need to move?
2	Is Pro priced to actually sell standalone, or is it deliberately a low-volume, high-intent gate in front of the website-build business?
3	Annual billing at launch, or add it once there's a few months of real monthly retention data to discount against?

One thing to decide before any number goes live

A real payment collection method. Right now plan status is set manually by an admin — bank transfer + the admin toggle is fine for the first ~10 paying shops, but it won't scale past that without real billing (e.g. a Lemon Squeezy / Stripe integration), which isn't built yet.